



Weekly Routines & Teaching Ideas

A Little Learners Companion Guide

Activities by age • Practical examples • Question prompts

TEACHER COMPANION



How to Use This Guide

Your everyday teaching companion



This guide gives you ideas, examples, and question prompts to use anytime — during the 6-Week Program or in your own daily teaching. Flip to the topic you need (colors, letters, shapes, vocabulary, or basic concepts), pick activities matched to your learner's age, and use the question prompts to go deeper.

What's inside

Weekly Routine Templates

Daily flows, 5-day rhythms, and time blocks you can copy.

Teaching by Topic

Colors, letters, shapes, vocabulary, basic concepts — by age.

Question Support

How to ask, what to ask, and what to do when they go quiet.

The Ideal Weekly Rhythm

Give each day its own focus

A simple themed-day rhythm makes the week predictable and exciting. Try this framework on top of any curriculum:



MON

Reading & Letters

Letter-of-the-day, alphabet songs, story time.

TUE

Math & Numbers

Counting games, number tracing, measuring.

WED

Create & Make

Art, music, crafts, building with blocks.

THU

World & Wonder

Science, nature, community helpers, our world.

FRI

Review & Celebrate

Reward chart, favorite activities, free choice.



Don't be rigid. If your child is loving Wednesday's art project, keep going! The themes are guides, not rules.

Daily Time Blocks

A 60-90 minute learning window

Most preschool learning happens in short, joyful bursts. Here's a flexible schedule that works for daycare, classroom, or kitchen-table homeschool.



Welcome & Circle Time

Greeting song, calendar, weather, today's theme.

Theme Introduction

Read a book, sing a song, introduce the day's letter, number, or topic.

Main Activity

Hands-on craft, worksheet, sorting game, or build.

Song & Movement

Dance, action song, jump and stretch — get the wiggles out.

Wind-Down

Quiet read-aloud, drawing, or a soft puzzle. Reward chart sticker.

Building a Consistent Routine

Predictability is preschool magic

Children thrive on repetition. Here's how to make routine your friend:



Same time every day

Your brain (and your child's) loves rhythm. Pick a time and stick with it.



Visual schedule

Even a simple picture chart helps non-readers know what's next.



Transitions matter

Use a song or chime to signal switching activities.



Start small

10-15 minutes is plenty at first. Build up gradually.



End on a high note

Always finish with something your child loves so they want to come back.



Repeat favorites

Don't rush to new content. Repetition = mastery.



If the routine breaks one day, no guilt. Just start again tomorrow. Consistency across weeks matters more than perfection on any one day.

Teaching Colors

Activities by age



Colors are visual anchors that help children categorize the world. Start with the primary colors, then build up to mixing, shades, and color words.

AGES 2-3

- Sort red blocks from blue blocks
- Point to all the red things in the room
- Color one color at a time
- Match a color sock to its pair

AGES 3-4

- Name colors in picture books
- Match objects to color circles
- Sing a rainbow song daily
- Go on a color hunt around the house

AGES 4-5

- Identify primary vs secondary
- Mix paints: red + yellow = orange
- Color by number
- Sort beads or buttons by color

AGES 5-6

- Sort by shades (light vs dark blue)
- Describe colors precisely
- Group items by warm vs cool
- Try basic color-mixing experiments



Colors — In Real Life



Practical moments + questions to ask



PRACTICAL EXAMPLES



At snack: "Let's eat all the red fruits first!"



Cleanup: "Blue toys in this basket, red in that one."



Getting dressed: "What color shirt should we wear today?"



Out and about: "I see a yellow car! Can you find one?"

QUESTIONS TO ASK



What color is this?



What's your favorite color and why?



How many colors do you see in this picture?



What would happen if we mixed red and blue?



Can you find something the same color as your shoes?



Which colors make you feel happy or calm?

Teaching Letters

Activities by age

Letter recognition is the foundation of reading. Make it playful — letters live everywhere, not just in books. Sound and shape both matter.



AGES 2-3

- Sing the alphabet song every day
- Point to the first letter of their name
- Trace letters in sand or shaving cream
- Read simple alphabet books

AGES 3-4

- Recognize the letters in their name
- Match uppercase letters
- Letter scavenger hunts in picture books
- Magnetic letters on the fridge

AGES 4-5

- Letter-sound matching: "A says ah"
- Practice writing their own name
- Identify every letter of the alphabet
- Play beginning-sound games

AGES 5-6

- Sound out simple words (cat, dog)
- Write short familiar words
- Letter formation practice on lined paper
- Tell stories you write down

★ Letters — In Real Life ★

Practical moments + questions to ask



PRACTICAL EXAMPLES

● At the store: "Find the letter M on a sign!"

● Reading time: "What letter does this story start with?"

● At meals: "Your name starts with S — find other S things."

● Crafts: "Make the letter B with playdough."

QUESTIONS TO ASK

● ? What letter does your name start with?

● ? What sound does that letter make?

● ? Can you find a letter A in this book?

● ? What other words start with the letter B?

● ? How do you write the letter D?

● ? What letters do you see in this word?

Teaching Shapes

Activities by age



Shapes are the building blocks of everything we see. Help children spot them in art, in nature, and in the world around them.

AGES 2-3

- Recognize circle and square
- Sort 2-shape blocks together
- Use a shape-sorter toy
- Trace circles in the air with a finger

AGES 3-4

- Name circle, square, triangle, rectangle
- Find shapes in the environment
- Cut out shape pictures from magazines
- Build with shape blocks

AGES 4-5

- Recognize 6+ shapes (oval, diamond, star)
- Draw shapes freehand
- Make pictures from shape cutouts
- Sort shapes by number of sides

AGES 5-6

- Introduce 3D shapes (cube, sphere)
- Talk about symmetry
- Make patterns with shapes
- Draw simple geometric pictures

★ Shapes — In Real Life ★

Practical moments + questions to ask



PRACTICAL EXAMPLES

At meals: "Your sandwich is a square. The plate is a circle!"

Outside: "Find a triangle somewhere on the playground."

Building: "What shapes can you build a house from?"

Drawing: "Draw a face using only shapes."

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- ? What shape is this?
- ? How many sides does it have?
- ? Can you find a circle anywhere in this room?
- ? What's different between a square and a rectangle?
- ? What shapes do you see in this picture?
- ? How is a triangle different from a circle?

Teaching Vocabulary

Activities by age



Every word a child learns is a window to a bigger world. Talk often, read often, and name things by their specific names — not just "that thingy."

AGES 2-3

- Name body parts and family members
- Use picture books for naming practice
- Repeat new words back to them
- Daily routine words (eat, sleep, play)

AGES 3-4

- Describing words: big, small, fast, soft
- Categories: animals, food, vehicles
- Action words: jump, hop, dance
- Color and shape vocabulary

AGES 4-5

- Pull new vocab from storybooks
- Synonyms: big/large/huge
- Days of the week
- Feeling words: excited, calm, frustrated

AGES 5-6

- Subject-specific words (science, art)
- Antonyms: hot/cold, up/down
- Months, seasons, weather words
- Talk about what a long word means



Vocabulary — In Real Life



Practical moments + questions to ask



PRACTICAL EXAMPLES

- During reading: pause and ask "What does that word mean?"
- At meals: "This is a pomegranate — not just a fruit."
- On walks: "That's a maple tree. See the leaf shape?"
- Daily activities: use real words ("scissors" not "thingy").

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- ? What's another word for ____?
- ? Can you tell me what that means?
- ? What's the opposite of fast?
- ? How would you describe this?
- ? What category does this fit in?
- ? Can you use that word in a sentence?

Teaching Basic Concepts

Activities by age

Basic concepts — opposites, positions, sizes, time — are the invisible scaffolding of learning. They show up in every subject for the rest of school.

AGES 2-3

- Opposites: hot/cold, big/small
- Position words: up, down, in, out
- One vs. many
- Name body parts and where they are

AGES 3-4

- More opposites: fast/slow, happy/sad
- Position: under, beside, between
- Sizes: big, bigger
- Same vs. different

AGES 4-5

- Comparing groups: more, less, equal
- Days of the week
- Time of day: morning, afternoon, night
- First, last, before, after

AGES 5-6

- Estimating quantities
- Measuring: longer, shorter, heavier
- Time on a clock (hours)
- Yesterday, today, tomorrow



Basic Concepts — In Real Life



Practical moments + questions to ask



PRACTICAL EXAMPLES



At bath time: "The water is warm. Was it cold before?"



Cleanup: "Put the bear UNDER the table."



At meals: "Who has MORE crackers? Who has LESS?"



Bedtime: "What did we do FIRST today? What did we do LAST?"

QUESTIONS TO ASK



What's the opposite of big?



Is this MORE or LESS than that?



Where is the cat? (Under the table? On the chair?)



Which one is the biggest?



What did we do this morning?



What day comes BEFORE Wednesday?

The 6 Types of Questions

Mix them all to grow young thinkers

Different question types build different thinking skills. The best teachers and parents move between all six naturally throughout the day.



1

Recall

Checking memory. "What color is this?"

2

Description

Encouraging words. "Tell me about your picture."

3

Comparison

Building reasoning. "How are these the same? Different?"

4

Prediction

Thinking ahead. "What do you think will happen?"

5

Inference

Going deeper. "Why do you think the bear is sad?"

6

Application

Connecting to life. "Where else have you seen this?"

Open-Ended Question Stems

Print this & keep it handy

Use these stems anytime — they all invite real thinking and longer answers.



? Tell me about...

? What do you notice?

? How did you...?

? Why do you think...?

? What if...?

? How could you...?

? What's another way to...?

? What happens when...?

? How are they alike?

? How are they different?

? What might happen next?

? What surprised you?

? What's your plan?

? What did you try?

? What would you change?

? How does this make you feel?



Pair any stem with what you're already doing. Reading a book? "Why do you think the rabbit ran away?" Cooking? "What might happen if we add more water?"

When Kids Don't Answer

Gentle strategies for quiet moments

Silence isn't failure — it's often thinking. But if your learner is stuck or shutting down, try one of these in order:



Wait 5-7 seconds

The 'magic pause.' Most adults rush in too fast — give real think time.



Rephrase simpler

Try shorter words or a yes/no version: "Is it red?"



Offer a choice

"Is it the big one or the little one?" — easier than open-ended.



Model the answer

"I think it's a triangle because it has three sides."



Use visuals

Point at the picture, hold the object, act it out.



Try again later

No pressure. Come back to the question in a fresh moment.

Quick Reference Card

Tear out and keep nearby

Everything you need on one page.



DAILY FLOW

1. Circle Time (15m)
2. Theme intro (20m)
3. Main activity (25m)
4. Song & movement (15m)
5. Wind-down (15m)

WEEKLY THEMES

- Mon — Reading & Letters
Tue — Math & Numbers
Wed — Create & Make
Thu — World & Wonder
Fri — Review & Celebrate

6 QUESTION TYPES

1. Recall — "What color?"
2. Describe — "Tell me about it."
3. Compare — "Same or different?"
4. Predict — "What's next?"
5. Infer — "Why?"
6. Apply — "Where else?"

WHEN THEY'RE QUIET

1. Wait 5-7 seconds
2. Rephrase simpler
3. Offer a choice
4. Model the answer
5. Use a visual
6. Try again later